Class 6 Social Science – Chapter 11

Grassroots Democracy – Part 2: Local Government in Rural Areas

नीचे NCERT की इस पाठ्यपुस्तक के सभी मुख्य प्रश्नों, गतिविधियों और अभ्यास प्रश्नों के उत्तर Simple English में दिए गए हैं। इसके बाद प्रत्येक टॉपिक से महत्वपूर्ण संभावित प्रश्न-उत्तर, definitions और revision notes भी दिए गए हैं। उत्तर कक्षा 6 के विद्यार्थियों के स्तर के अनुसार रखे गए हैं।

1. The Big Questions – Answers

Q1. What are Panchayati Raj institutions?

Answer: Panchayati Raj institutions are local self-government bodies in rural areas. They help villagers take decisions about local problems and village development.

Q2. What are their functions?

Answer: Their main functions are to maintain roads, manage water resources, support agriculture, improve education and healthcare, promote sanitation, and implement government schemes.

Q3. Why are they important in governance and democracy?

Answer: They bring government closer to the people. Villagers can participate in decision-making, elect their representatives, discuss local problems, and help develop their villages.

2. Textbook Questions, Activities and Answers

Q1. Name the three tiers of the Panchayati Raj system. What are the key functions of each tier?

Answer: The Panchayati Raj system has three tiers:

Tier	Institution	Main functions
Village level	Gram Panchayat	Looks after village roads, water, sanitation, schools and other local needs.
Block level	Panchayat Samiti	Coordinates the work and development plans of Gram Panchayats in the block.
District level	Zila Parishad	Coordinates development work at the district level and helps plan and arrange resources.

Q2. Write a letter to the Sarpanch about plastic bags lying on the roadside in the village.

To,
The Sarpanch,
Gram Panchayat,
[Name of the Village]

Subject: Removal of plastic bags from village roads

Respected Sir/Madam,

I wish to draw your attention to the plastic bags lying on the roadsides in our village. They make the village dirty, block drains and may harm animals.

I request you to arrange for the proper collection and disposal of plastic waste. Dustbins should be placed at suitable places, and villagers should be encouraged to avoid single-use plastic bags.

I hope you will take quick action to keep our village clean and healthy.

Thank you.

Yours faithfully,
A Student
[School Name]

Q3. In your view, what type of person should be a Gram Panchayat member?

Answer: A Gram Panchayat member should be honest, responsible, helpful and hardworking. The person should listen to everyone, respect all communities, understand local problems and work for the welfare of the village without discrimination.

Q4. A village school is next to a highway, and students find it difficult to cross the road. What are the possible solutions? Which Panchayati Raj institutions can help? What can students do?

Answer:

Possible solutions:

1. Request the authorities to construct a footbridge or provide a safe crossing, where suitable.
2. Ask for speed breakers, warning signs and a pedestrian crossing, subject to the highway authority's approval.
3. Request traffic police or other authorised personnel to help students cross safely during school hours.

4. Create awareness among drivers about school-zone safety.

Institutions that can help:

- The Gram Panchayat can raise the issue and submit a request to the concerned authorities.
- The Panchayat Samiti can coordinate the matter at the block level.
- The Zila Parishad can help take up the issue at the district level.

Since the road is a highway, the concerned road authority and traffic police may also need to take action.

What students can do: Students can inform their teachers and parents, prepare a written request, and ask the school to contact the Panchayat. They should use a safe crossing and never run across the highway.

3. Answers to “Think About It” and “Let’s Explore”

Q1. How can old maps be helpful? Can they tell us about the past and the present?

Answer: Old maps help us understand how a village or area looked in the past. By comparing old and new maps, we can learn about changes in land boundaries, roads, rivers, fields and settlements. They may also help in understanding old land records.

Q2. What is a Child-Friendly Panchayat Initiative?

Answer: The Child-Friendly Panchayat Initiative gives children opportunities to express their views and discuss matters that affect their well-being. It encourages children to take part in Bal Sabhas and Bal Panchayats.

Q3. How can a Bal Panchayat help children?

Answer: A Bal Panchayat can raise issues such as child labour, child marriage, school attendance, sanitation and children's safety. Its members can talk to parents and adults and encourage them to protect children's rights.

Q4. How did the Sangkhu Radhu Khandu Gram Panchayat help children?

Answer: The Gram Panchayat in West Sikkim built compound walls around schools to make them safer. It also constructed kitchens so that children could receive hygienically cooked mid-day meals. These efforts helped it become known as a child-friendly Gram Panchayat.

Q5. What was the Children's Parliament initiative in Rajasthan?

Answer: The Children's Parliament was connected with the Barefoot College initiative started by Bunker Roy. It involved children aged 8–14 in education and democratic activities. Children elected representatives, formed a cabinet and worked on issues such as education, sanitation and social equality.

Q6. What issues could a Gram Sabha discuss in a village?

Answer: A Gram Sabha could discuss:

- Drinking water and irrigation.
- Village roads and streetlights.
- Cleanliness and waste disposal.
- School facilities and children's safety.
- Health services and sanitation.
- Welfare schemes and support for disadvantaged people.

Q7. What challenges could a Gram Sabha face, and what solutions could it suggest?

Answer: It may face a shortage of funds, disagreements among villagers, lack of awareness or delays in government work. It can discuss problems openly, make priorities, prepare development plans, seek government funds and monitor the work.

Q8. Why should the government pay special attention to disadvantaged sections of society?

Answer: Disadvantaged people may have fewer resources and fewer opportunities to express their needs. Special attention helps protect their rights, reduce inequality and ensure that development benefits everyone.

Q9. What similarities and differences are there between the Central Government and Panchayat-level governance?

Answer:

Similarities:

- Both work for the welfare of people.
- Both have representatives and defined responsibilities.
- Both make plans and use resources to solve problems.
- Both are expected to follow laws and democratic procedures.

Differences:

- The Central Government deals with national matters, while Panchayats deal mainly with local rural matters.
- The Central Government works across the country, while a Gram Panchayat works in a village or group of villages.
- Panchayati Raj institutions focus on local needs such as village roads, water, sanitation and community development.

Q10. What questions can students ask Panchayat members?

Answer: Students can ask:

1. What are the main problems in our village?
2. How are decisions taken in the Gram Panchayat?
3. How are funds used for village development?
4. What steps are taken to keep the village clean?
5. How does the Panchayat support schools and children's safety?
6. How can villagers raise complaints?
7. How are women and disadvantaged groups involved in decision-making?

Q11. What is the Arthaśhāstra? What does it tell us about administration?

Answer: The Arthaśhāstra is an ancient text on governance written by Kauṭilya, also known as Chāṇakya, about 2,300 years ago. It discusses how a state should be organised and governed. It also describes an administrative structure from villages to higher administrative centres.

Q12. What lesson do we learn from the example of Hiware Bazar?

Answer: Hiware Bazar in Maharashtra faced frequent droughts and poor agricultural production. Under Sarpanch Popatrao Baguji Pawar, villagers worked on rainwater harvesting, watershed conservation and tree planting. These efforts helped recharge groundwater and made the village greener and more prosperous.

Q13. What do the examples of Dnyaneshwar Kamble and Vandana Bahadur Maida teach us?

Answer: These examples show that leadership should be based on ability and public service, not gender or social identity. They also show that Sarpanchs can encourage people to participate and work for education, sanitation and village development.

4. Important Questions and Answers from Every Topic

Topic A: Panchayati Raj System

Q1. What is a Panchayat?

Answer: A Panchayat is a village council that looks after local governance and development.

Q2. What is Panchayati Raj?

Answer: Panchayati Raj is the system of local self-government in rural areas.

Q3. Why is Panchayati Raj called self-government?

Answer: It is called self-government because local people participate in decisions about their own villages through meetings and elected representatives.

Q4. What is a three-tier system?

Answer: A three-tier system is a system of administration organised at three levels: village, block and district.

Q5. Why is local government needed in villages?

Answer: Villages have local needs such as roads, drinking water, irrigation, sanitation and school facilities. Local government can understand and address these needs more directly.

Q6. What areas of life are covered by Panchayati Raj institutions?

Answer: They deal with agriculture, housing, roads, water resources, education, healthcare, social welfare and cultural activities.

Topic B: Gram Sabha and Gram Panchayat

Q7. What is a Gram Sabha?

Answer: A Gram Sabha consists of adult members of a village, or a group of neighbouring villages, who are enrolled as voters.

Q8. What does the Gram Sabha do?

Answer: Its members discuss matters affecting the village, share their views and take part in local decision-making.

Q9. What is a Gram Panchayat?

Answer: A Gram Panchayat is the elected local government body at the village level.

Q10. Who is the head of a Gram Panchayat?

Answer: The head is called the Sarpanch or Pradhan.

Q11. How are the members of a Gram Panchayat chosen?

Answer: They are elected by local voters through elections.

Q12. What is the difference between a Gram Sabha and a Gram Panchayat?

Answer: The Gram Sabha is the body of eligible adult voters who participate in discussions and decisions. The Gram Panchayat is the elected body responsible for carrying out local governance and development work.

Q13. What is the role of a Panchayat Secretary?

Answer: A Panchayat Secretary performs administrative tasks, such as calling meetings and maintaining records.

Q14. Who is a Patwari?

Answer: A Patwari is an official who maintains village land records and, in many areas, land maps.

Topic C: Panchayat Samiti and Zila Parishad

Q15. What is a Panchayat Samiti?

Answer: A Panchayat Samiti is a Panchayati Raj institution at the block level. It connects Gram Panchayats with the Zila Parishad.

Q16. What are the main functions of a Panchayat Samiti?

Answer: It coordinates work among Gram Panchayats, collects their development plans and helps present these plans at higher levels for resources and support.

Q17. What is a Zila Parishad?

Answer: A Zila Parishad is a Panchayati Raj institution at the district level.

Q18. What is the role of a Zila Parishad?

Answer: It coordinates rural development planning at the district level and helps bring together local development needs and resources.

Q19. How do the three tiers work together?

Answer: The Gram Panchayat identifies village needs, the Panchayat Samiti coordinates plans across the block, and the Zila Parishad coordinates development matters at the district level.

Q20. What is the Pradhan Mantri Gram Sadak Yojana?

Answer: It is a government scheme that promotes the construction of all-weather roads in rural areas.

Topic D: Representation and Inclusion

Q21. Why is the participation of women important in Panchayats?

Answer: Women's participation helps bring their experiences and concerns into decision-making. It also gives women opportunities to lead and contribute to village development.

Q22. What provision for women is mentioned in the chapter?

Answer: The chapter states that Panchayati Raj institutions have a provision for reserving one-third of the seats for women.

Q23. Why should disadvantaged groups be represented?

Answer: Their representation helps ensure that their problems and needs are heard and considered in development plans.

Q24. What qualities should a good Sarpanch have?

Answer: A good Sarpanch should be honest, fair, responsible, hardworking and willing to listen to all villagers.

Topic E: Children and Local Governance

Q25. Why should Panchayats listen to children?

Answer: Children are affected by decisions about schools, sanitation, safety and other local services. Listening to them helps protect their rights and improve their well-being.

Q26. What is a Bal Sabha?

Answer: A Bal Sabha is a forum where children can discuss their concerns and share their views.

Q27. How can a Panchayat help prevent child labour and child marriage?

Answer: It can raise awareness, work with parents, encourage children to attend school and support efforts to protect children's rights.

Q28. How can children participate in village development?

Answer: They can raise problems through Bal Sabhas, keep their surroundings clean, spread awareness and share suggestions with teachers, parents and Panchayat members.

Topic F: Ancient Administration

Q29. Who wrote the Arthaśhāstra?

Answer: The Arthaśhāstra was written by Kauṭilya, also known as Chāṇakya.

Q30. What administrative arrangement is described in the chapter from the Arthaśhāstra?

Answer: It describes administrative centres for groups of 10, 100, 400 and 800 villages. This shows that an organised system of administration was discussed in ancient India.

Q31. What is the main lesson of the chapter?

Answer: Local democracy allows people to participate in governance, solve local problems and work together for the development of their villages.

5. Important Terms and Definitions

Term	Simple meaning
Local Government	Government that looks after the needs of a local area.
Panchayat	A village council.
Panchayati Raj	The system of local self-government in rural areas.
Self-government	People managing their local affairs through participation and representatives.
Three-tier system	Administration at village, block and district levels.
Gram Sabha	Adult village voters enrolled as members of the Sabha.
Gram Panchayat	The elected local government body at the village level.
Sarpanch / Pradhan	The head of the Gram Panchayat.
Panchayat Secretary	An official who helps with administrative work and records.
Patwari	An official who maintains land records.
Panchayat Samiti	The Panchayati Raj institution at the block level.
Zila Parishad	The Panchayati Raj institution at the district level.
Bal Sabha	A forum for children to discuss their concerns.
Bal Panchayat	A child-focused body that helps children participate in discussions about their needs.
Child-Friendly Panchayat	A Panchayat that gives importance to children's needs, safety and rights.
Development Plan	A plan to improve facilities and services in an area.
Social Welfare	Activities and services that improve people's well-being.

Arthaśhāstra	An ancient Indian text on governance associated with Kauṭilya.
Rainwater Harvesting	Collecting and storing rainwater for future use.
Watershed Conservation	Protecting and managing land and water in an area that drains into a common water body.

6. Multiple-Choice Questions (MCQs)

Practice Test

0 of 15 answered

1. Panchayati Raj mainly works in which areas?

A. Urban areas
B. Rural areas
C. Only state capitals
D. Only national parks

2. How many tiers are there in the Panchayati Raj system described in the chapter?

A. Two
B. Three
C. Four
D. Five

3. Which institution works at the village level?

A. Zila Parishad
B. Parliament
C. Gram Panchayat
D. Panchayat Samiti

4. The head of a Gram Panchayat is called the:

A. Governor
B. Sarpanch or Pradhan
C. District Judge
D. Patwari

5. The Gram Sabha consists of:

A. Only government officers
B. Only teachers
C. Adult village voters enrolled as members
D. Only Panchayat employees

6. Which institution works at the block level?

A. Gram Sabha
B. Panchayat Samiti
C. Zila Parishad
D. Supreme Court

7. Which institution works at the district level?

A. Gram Panchayat
B. Gram Sabha
C. Zila Parishad
D. Bal Sabha

8. Who maintains village land records in many parts of India?

A. Sarpanch
B. Patwari
C. Student leader
D. School principal

9. Who helps maintain Panchayat records and call meetings?

A. Panchayat Secretary
B. Patwari only
C. Governor
D. Police officer

10. The Panchayat Samiti connects the Gram Panchayat with the:

A. School
B. Zila Parishad
C. Supreme Court
D. Parliament

11. Which scheme promotes all-weather rural roads?

A. PM Gram Sadak Yojana
B. Children's Parliament
C. Bal Sabha Yojana
D. Arthaśhāstra Yojana

12. The *Arthaśhāstra* is associated with:

A. M. K. Gandhi
B. Kauṭilya

C. Popatrao Pawar
D. Bunker Roy

13. The Child-Friendly Panchayat Initiative encourages children to:

A. Stop attending school
B. Express their views on matters affecting them
C. Avoid village meetings
D. Work instead of studying

14. Hiware Bazar worked on water conservation and:

A. Building airports
B. Tree planting
C. Mining coal
D. Expanding factories

15. According to the chapter, what proportion of seats is reserved for women in these institutions?

A. One-fourth
B. One-third
C. One-half in every case
D. One-tenth
Check Answers

7. True or False

Write True or False for each statement.

1. Panchayati Raj is a system of local self-government in rural areas. — True
2. The Panchayati Raj system described in the chapter has three tiers. — True
3. The Gram Panchayat works at the district level. — False
4. The Sarpanch or Pradhan is the head of the Gram Panchayat. — True
5. The Gram Sabha includes adult voters enrolled as members. — True
6. The Panchayat Samiti works at the block level. — True
7. The Zila Parishad works at the village level. — False
8. A Patwari maintains land records in many parts of India. — True
9. Panchayats should ignore children's concerns. — False
10. The Child-Friendly Panchayat Initiative supports children's participation. — True
11. Panchayati Raj institutions work only on agriculture. — False
12. Hiware Bazar benefited from water conservation and tree planting. — True
13. The Panchayat Samiti helps coordinate development plans. — True
14. The Arthaśhāstra is associated with Kauṭilya. — True
15. Local government helps people participate in village development. — True

8. Quick Revision Notes

Remember these key points before the examination:

- Panchayati Raj: Local self-government in rural areas.
- Three tiers: Gram Panchayat (village), Panchayat Samiti (block), Zila Parishad (district).
- Gram Sabha: Adult voters enrolled as members who discuss village matters.
- Sarpanch/Pradhan: Head of the Gram Panchayat.
- Panchayat Secretary: Helps with meetings and records.
- Patwari: Maintains land records in many parts of India.
- Panchayat Samiti: Coordinates work among Gram Panchayats.
- Zila Parishad: Coordinates development matters at the district level.
- Child-Friendly Panchayat: Gives importance to children's rights, safety and needs.
- Hiware Bazar: An example of village development through water conservation and tree planting.
- Women's participation: The chapter mentions a provision for reserving one-third of seats for women.
- Main aim: To let villagers participate in decisions and manage local development.

Exam tip: Learn the difference between the Gram Sabha and Gram Panchayat, remember all three tiers in the correct order, and practise the four textbook exercise answers. These are central concepts of Chapter 11.